

Calls for stronger China action grows

送信者: POLITICO Pro Morning Mobility Europe 受信日時: 2026-09-11 14:02

【要点】

- ・ 欧州議会が中国に対するより厳しい通商措置を求める機運が高まっており、特に原材料やバッテリー、電気自動車などの技術でEUの中国依存を低減することを求めている。
- ・ EUの政治勢力間で中国との通商問題について強硬姿勢が主流化しつつあり、議会内での統一的立場構築の可能性が高まっている。
- ・ 従来は中国に友好的な姿勢を示していたドイツが、自動車業界への報復懸念から方針転換する可能性があると言われていた。
- ・ 欧州産業保護政策としての産業加速法案において、「欧州製」の定義をより厳しくする方向が支持されている。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — The European Parliament is coale

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By JORDYN DAHL

with MARTINA SAPIO

View in your browser or listen to audio

SNEAK PEEK

— The European Parliament is coalescing around the EU taking stronger trade action against China as lawmakers fret over the bloc's deindustrialization.

— Train drivers across Poland are planning a nationwide protest today following a series of accidents, slowing to 20 kilometers per hour at every level crossing.

— The U.K. government asked the country's aviation authority to review this week's air traffic outage that grounded thousands of flights.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

Mark your calendars: Our weekly mobility calendar landed in your inbox on Thursday. You can also go online to export and plan your week or suggest your own event.

DRIVING THE DAY

MOMENTUM BUILDING FOR STRONGER CHINA POLICY: The European Parliament's Foreign Affairs Committee asked the European Commission on Thursday to take "urgent action" to decrease the bloc's reliance on China for raw materials, batteries and electric vehicles, among other clean technologies.

Sounds familiar: Pressure is building across the EU for more stringent trade and economic measures to protect European industries from Chinese competition, overcapacity and cheaper prices. The Commission's Industrial Accelerator Act is the prime example, with a public hearing earlier this month focusing entirely on the China threat. Parliament is increasingly favoring a more restrictive approach to what qualifies as "Made in Europe" under the regulation — a call the Foreign Affairs Committee reaffirmed on Thursday.

Building consensus: The Parliament's point person on trade relations with China — French MEP Pascal Canfin of the liberal Renew Europe group — sees a more hawkish approach becoming mainstream across political groups, he told our colleague Carlo Martuscelli. "I'm not saying that it's a done deal, but I think we can really win this battle within the Parliament," he said, referring to creating a joint stance on firmer trade actions against China.

Germany coming around?: Member countries are split on how far to go in erecting safeguards against Chinese dumping, but Canfin is optimistic that Germany in particular is coming around. Berlin has historically had a pro-China stance in the Council over fears of retaliation from Beijing against its prized automotive sector. "The German government has always considered that what's good for BMW, BASF, and Mercedes is good for everybody," the MEP said. "Today, that could be challenged."

Yes, but: German Chancellor Friedrich Merz is facing an existential political crisis after the Alternative for Germany's landslide victory in the Saxony-Anhalt regional election last weekend. Polls show the far-right party is poised to pull similar numbers in two additional state elections later this month. If Merz's government falls, China will likely be pushed further down the list of priorities, Jörg Wuttke, a longtime China watcher who briefed Merz ahead of his February visit to Beijing, told Jordyn earlier this week.

Bad timing: The bloc's decisions will come to a head in mid-October during the next Council meeting, where Commission President Ursula von der Leyen is expected to present the Commission's strategy and potential trade actions. Trade Commissioner Maroš Šefčovič is also heading to Beijing in October — a visit seen as pivotal to getting concessions from China before ratcheting up the economic pressure.

Silver lining: Beijing has made some moves to curb its automakers from bringing their price war from China to Europe, putting out national guidelines telling the brands to "not disrupt market competition order to gain unfair competitive advantages," according to a Sept. 2 notice (available here in Mandarin).

RAIL

POLISH TRAIN DRIVERS TO SLOW TRAINS IN SAFETY PROTEST: Train drivers across Poland are planning a nationwide protest today, slowing to 20 kph at every level crossing in a move expected to cause significant delays.

Why now: The action follows Wednesday's deadly crash near Sokolniki Suche, where an Intercity train from Lublin to Szczecin struck a concrete-mixer truck at a level crossing and derailed. One passenger was killed and around 20 people were injured, including the train driver and the truck driver.

"Red line" crossed: Local media report that Polish train drivers' union says repeated accidents at level crossings have become unacceptable, claiming such incidents occur on average every other day. Union

chief Leszek Miętek said there were roughly 180 rail accidents last year and around 130 so far this year.

Government response: Prime Minister Donald Tusk said the government would work on tougher rules and penalties for drivers who ignore red lights or barriers at railway crossings, while Deputy Infrastructure Minister Piotr Malepszak pointed to shortcomings in driver training.

Expect disruption: Drivers say they will use existing labour-law safety provisions to justify the slowdown and acknowledge delays could be substantial, arguing a day of disruption is preferable to more deaths on the tracks. POLITICO contacted both the Infrastructure Ministry and the train drivers' union for additional comment, but neither responded.

LOGISTICS

RUSSIA TARGETS ESTONIA'S BORDER LOGISTICS: Estonia is under a Russian propaganda onslaught over border controls even though it still offers the region's most flexible routes into Russia, according to an analysis by Estonian disinformation watchdog Propastop.

The logistics reality: Estonia keeps three crossings open — Narva for pedestrians and Koidula and Luhamaa for vehicles — while Latvia has only two vehicle-only crossings and Finland has closed its land border to passenger traffic entirely, leaving only freight trains through Vainikkala.

Propaganda gap: Despite that, Russian media has repeatedly portrayed Estonia's border system as chaotic and punitive, focusing on long queues, shortened opening hours, possible closures and customs checks. Propastop counted dozens of negative stories about Estonia over the summer, while Latvia received little attention and coverage of Finland focused mostly on the economic damage caused by its border closure.

MARITIME

BATTERY CARGO RULES UNDER FIRE: The World Shipping Council, which represents the international liner shipping industry, is urging governments to close what it says is a dangerous loophole in global shipping rules that can allow containers packed with thousands of lithium batteries to move without being declared as dangerous goods.

The gap: Under the IMO's Special Provision 188, smaller batteries can be exempt from some dangerous-goods requirements if they meet testing, packaging and capacity rules — but there is no cap on how many exempt batteries can be packed into a single container.

What WSC wants: Backed by five governments and several industry groups, the council has submitted an IMO paper proposing a maximum container-level threshold, above which battery shipments would have to be declared and potentially placarded.

What's next: Governments will take up the issue at the IMO's cargo safety subcommittee in London next week, as battery shipments keep rising and container fires remain a persistent concern.

HOUTHIS TIGHTEN GRIP ON RED SEA SHIPPING: Houthi forces have reportedly seized Yemen's strategic Zuqar island after taking control of Mocha, according to local media.

Why shipping cares: Zuqar sits in the southern Red Sea, close to the approaches to the Bab el-Mandeb Strait and alongside major international shipping lanes linking the Suez Canal with the Gulf of Aden. Local outlet Erem News reported that Houthi forces completed their takeover of Mocha before sending military boats toward Zuqar following ballistic missile strikes on the island.

AVIATION

LESSONS LEARNED: The U.K. government says it is important that “lessons are learned” after an air traffic control outage brought thousands of flights to a standstill on Tuesday and Wednesday.

Investigation underway: The National Air Traffic Services has since promised a full investigation to establish what happened and identify any further action needed. In addition, the government has asked the Civil Aviation Authority to conduct an independent review and present an update in six months’ time. A No 10 spokesperson on Wednesday refused to say whether the government had confidence in NATS CEO Martin Rolfe as calls mounted for him to resign.

Lessons learned: Speaking in parliament on Thursday, Transport Minister Keir Mather said “an enormous amount of economic growth” was dependent on the civil aviation sector functioning effectively, “whether that be through air freight, the movement of business travelers to where they need to go, or facilitating the U.K. tourism industry.”

Freight fears: Pawel Jarza, external affairs director at the British International Freight Association, told our colleague Sophie Inge that large volumes of freight had been affected by the disruption. Although the technical issue has now been resolved, Jarza warned that the knock-on effects were “likely to continue for several days,” especially for urgent, time-sensitive or specialist consignments like critical components for the automotive, technology and manufacturing sectors.

RUSSIA’S AIRPORTS RATION JET FUEL: At least 26 major Russian airports have introduced limits on aircraft refuelling, according to an analysis by independent outlet Verstka of notices in the country’s aeronautical information system.

Foreign carriers hit hardest: In 15 of the 26 airports, the restrictions apply only to foreign airlines, which are generally allowed to take on only enough fuel for a single flight. The measures cover airports including Yekaterinburg, Kazan, Ufa, Vladivostok and Khabarovsk.

PIT STOPS

From us : National delegations from the EPP are divided over how far the IAA should go in setting manufacturing targets or strict local content requirements.

Volkswagen estimates that its cost-cutting plan that will cull 100,000 jobs will cost the German automaker €16 billion, Reuters reports .

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Document: Parliament’s draft ETS report toughens spending rules for countries

Lead MEP Peter Liese’s changes to the Commission’s reform proposal also include tweaks to emissions trajectory.

By Zia Weise · Sept 10, 2026, 05:26 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: EPP delegations push back on EU’s ‘Made in Europe’ plans

By Jordyn Dahl · Sept 10, 2026, 05:22 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU finalizes deal to share traveler data with US border forces

By Ellen O'Regan · Sept 10, 2026, 03:34 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Von der Leyen backs space mega-deal despite looming EU antitrust probe
Brussels officials typically refrain from commenting on ongoing investigations.
By Francesca Micheletti · Sept 10, 2026, 03:05 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Weekly Calendar

Here's a selection of upcoming key events, find the complete Week Ahead online.

Cepol 'European Travel Information and Authorisation System (ETIAS)' webinar
Sep 15, 2026 · Online

POLITICO Pro Petit-Déjeuner – Sénatoriales : petits et grands changements en perspective !
Sep 15, 2026, 8:15 AM - 10:00 am

Pro Roundtable – Energy & Climate UK
Sep 15, 2026, 9:00 AM - 11:00 am

AIQ Webinar | European Regulatory View to the End of the Year
Sep 15, 2026, 4:00 PM - 4:45 pm

Even following the slow summer months, there's a bevy of moving policy pieces impacting life sciences companies operating in the EU and for regulatory professionals to catch up on. In this back-to-school webinar, AgencyIQ experts will provide a status check on key legislation affecting regulatory stakeholders, including the Pharma Package, Critical Medicines Act and Biotech I. We'll also cover key developments in the proposed adjustments to the medical device regulation and in vitro diagnostic regulations.

European Mobility Week
Sep 16, 2026 - Sep 22, 2026 · Brussels, BE

State of the Union by President Ursula Von der Leyen
Sep 16, 2026 · Strasbourg, FR

Coreper II
Sep 16, 2026 · Brussels, BE

CANSO 'Strengthening ATSEP Competence — Training, Best Practices and Future Needs' webinar
Sep 17, 2026 · Online

Pro Roundtable – Tech UK
Sep 17, 2026, 9:00 AM - 11:00 am

IATA Integrated Sustainability Program Workshop
Sep 18, 2026 · New Delhi, IN

Eurogroup
Sep 18, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Transport — Intermodal Questions and Networks
Sep 18, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council informal meeting of transport ministers

Sep 20, 2026 - Sep 21, 2026 · Brussels, BE

This email alert has been sent for your exclusive use as a POLITICO Pro subscriber. Forwarding or reproducing the newsletter without the express, written permission of POLITICO Pro is a violation of the POLITICO Pro license agreement.

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp

[Update settings](#) | [Unsubscribe from this email](#) | [Unsubscribe from all emails](#)

POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium